

AUTOMATION

What

The Automation component uses ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate the processing of Network Requests submitted through the Service Catalog.

The flow is triggered when a user submits the Network Request catalog item. It retrieves the submitted catalog variables, creates a corresponding record in the Network Database table, sends an email notification, requests approval, evaluates the approval result, and updates the Network Database record accordingly.

The automation reduces manual intervention and ensures that every request follows a standardized processing lifecycle.

Why

Without automation, network requests would require administrators or fulfilment teams to manually:

- Read submitted request information.
- Create corresponding database records.
- Notify relevant users.
- Request approvals.
- Check approval results.
- Update request status.

Automating these activities improves processing speed, consistency, traceability, and reliability.

Activity 1 – Creation of Flow

What

Create a Flow Designer flow named **Network Request** to control the automated lifecycle of the submitted catalog request.

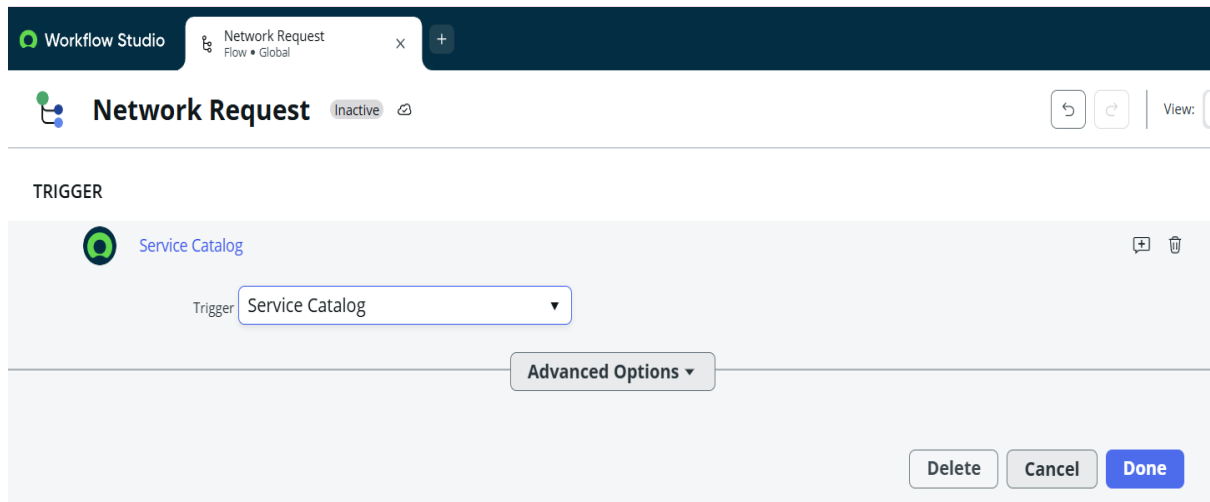
How

1. Navigate to **Flow Designer**.
2. Open the Flow Designer home page.
3. Click **New**.
4. Select **Flow**.
5. Enter: **Flow Name:** Network Request

6. Provide an appropriate description, for example:

Automates the processing, approval, notification, and status update of Network Request catalog submissions.

7. Click **Build Flow**.



Activity 2 – Configure Trigger

What

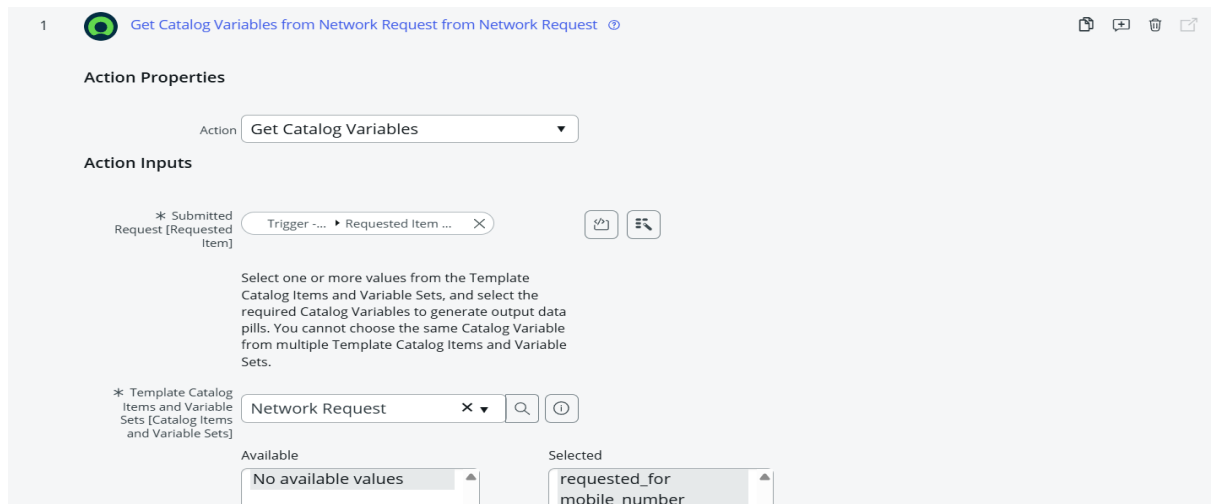
Configure the flow to start automatically when the Network Request catalog item is submitted.

Why

A Service Catalog trigger ensures that automation begins immediately when a user submits a request instead of requiring an administrator to manually initiate the process.

How

1. Open the **Network Request** flow.
2. Click the (+) icon in the Trigger section.
3. Select the appropriate Service Catalog trigger.
4. Configure the trigger for the Network Request catalog submission.
5. Click **Done**.



Activity 3 – Configure Flow Actions

The flow contains several actions that process the submitted request.

3.1 Get Catalog Variables

What

Retrieve the variables entered by the user in the Network Request catalog item.

Why

The submitted catalog variables contain the information required to create and process the corresponding Network Database record.

How

1. Click Add an Action.
2. Search for:
Get Catalog Variables
3. Select Get Catalog Variables.
4. Configure the action input using the catalog request's Requested Item from the trigger.
5. Select the appropriate catalog item:

Network Request

6. Select the required variables.
7. Move the required variables into the selected area.
8. Click **Done**.

Capture the action showing:

- Requested Item input

- Network Request catalog item
- Selected variables

The screenshot shows the Workflow Studio interface for a workflow named 'Network Request'. The workflow is currently 'Inactive'. The 'ACTIONS' panel shows two steps:

1. Get Catalog Variables from Network Request from Network Request
2. Create Network Database Record

The 'Create Network Database Record' action is selected, and its properties are displayed:

- Action:** Create Record
- Action Inputs:**
 - * Table:** Network Database [u_network_d...]
 - Request For:** 1 - Get Catalog... ▶ requested...
 - Mobile number:** 1 - Get Catalo... ▶ mobile_nu...
 - Existing ID:** 1 - Get C... ▶ enter_your_exist...
 - Total amount:** 1 - Get Catalog ... ▶ total_amo...
 - Customer Address:** 1 - Get Catalog Vari... ▶ addre...
 - opened on behalf of:** 1 - Get Ca... ▶ opened on beh...

3.2 Create Record

What

Create a new record in the **Network Database** table using the information retrieved from the catalog variables.

Why

The catalog submission represents the user's request, while the Network Database record provides a structured record that can be used for approval, fulfilment, tracking, and reporting.

How

1. Add a new action.
2. Select **Create Record**.
3. Select the table:

Network Database

4. Click **Add Fields**.
5. Map the appropriate catalog-variable outputs to the corresponding Network Database fields.
6. Configure all required fields.

7. Click **Done**.

3.3 Send Email

What

Send an email notification after the Network Database record is created.

Why

Notifications keep requesters and relevant stakeholders informed without requiring them to manually check the system.

How

1. Add a **Send Email** action.
2. Set the target record to the record created by the **Create Record** action.
3. Configure the recipient fields:
 - **To**
 - **CC**, if required
 - **BCC**, if required
4. Use static or dynamic recipients as appropriate.
5. Configure the email **Subject**.
6. Configure the email **Body**.
7. Click **Done**.

Where possible, use dynamic values from the flow rather than hard-coded information.

The screenshot shows the configuration for a 'Send Email' action within a workflow titled 'Network Request'. The interface is divided into 'Action Properties' and 'Action Inputs' sections.

Action Properties:

- Action:** A dropdown menu showing 'Send Email'.

Action Inputs:

- Target Record:** A field showing '2 - Cr... > Network Database ...' with a search icon.
- Table:** A dropdown menu showing 'Network Database [u_network_d...' with a search icon.
- Include Watermark:** A checked checkbox.
- * To:** A text field containing 'banna.madhuri27@gmail.com'.
- CC:** An empty text field.
- BCC:** An empty text field.
- * Subject:** A text field containing 'Request has been Created'.
- Body:** A large text area containing '2 - Cr... > Network Database ...' and 'Hello'.

Outcome

An automated notification is generated for the appropriate recipient after the Network Database record is created.

Network Request (Inactive) View

* To: banna.madhuri27@gmail.com

CC:

BCC: Send Email

* Subject: Request has been Created

2 - Cr... > Network Database ...

Hello

We have been received your request with request number:

Sorry for the Inconvenience and Your request will resolved with in 2 Business working days.

Thanks for contacting us.

Network Team.

Delete Cancel Done

3.4 Ask for Approval

What

Configure an approval action to obtain authorization for the Network Request.

Why

Network-related requests may require authorization before fulfilment. Automating approval ensures that requests follow the organization's defined control process.

How

1. Add the **Ask for Approval** action.
2. Select the target record created by the **Create Record** action.
3. Enter the approval reason:

Waiting for approval

4. Configure the required approval rules.
5. Select the appropriate approval behavior, such as:
 - Anyone approves
 - Everyone approves
6. Configure static or dynamic approvers according to the requirement.

The screenshot shows the 'Network Request' configuration page. At the top, there's a header with the title 'Network Request' and a status 'Inactive'. Below the header, the main configuration area is titled 'Ask For Approval on Network Database'. It includes sections for 'Action Properties' and 'Action Inputs'. Under 'Action Properties', the 'Action' is set to 'Ask For Approval'. Under 'Action Inputs', there are fields for 'Record' (set to '2 - Cr...'), 'Table' (set to 'Network Database [u_network_d...')', 'Approval Reason' (set to 'Wait for Approval'), 'Approval Field' (set to 'Select a field'), and 'Journal Field' (set to 'Select a field'). At the bottom, there's a 'Rules' section with a dropdown set to 'Approve' and a 'When' condition set to 'Anyone approves' and 'System Administrator'. There are also buttons for 'Add another OR rule set' and logical operators 'OR' and 'AND'.

3.5 Flow Logic – Approval Decision

What

Add conditional logic to determine what happens based on the approval result.

Why

Approved and rejected requests require different processing paths. Conditional flow logic ensures that the correct action is taken automatically.

How

1. Add **Flow Logic**.
2. Select **If**.
3. Configure the condition using the approval action's state.
4. Set the condition to:

Approval State = Approved

3.6 Update Record – Approved Path

What

Update the Network Database record when the approval is successful.

Why

The request record must reflect the latest stage of the lifecycle so that fulfilment teams and users can understand its current status.

How

1. Inside the **Approved** branch, add **Update Record**.
2. Select the record generated by the **Create Record** action.
3. Select the Network Database record.
4. Configure the required fields.
5. Set the appropriate approved status/value.
6. Click **Done**.

The screenshot shows a workflow editor with a vertical list of steps on the left: 2. Create Network Database Record, 3. Send Email, 4. Ask For Approval on Network Database, and 5. If. Step 5 is selected and expanded. The 'If' condition is configured with the label 'If Request is Approved'. Below the label, there is a condition set: '4 - Ask For Ap... Approval St...' is 'Approved'. The condition is set to 'or' and 'and' buttons are visible. At the bottom of the condition set, there is a button 'Add another condition set(OR)'. At the bottom right of the 'If' configuration panel, there are buttons 'Delete', 'Cancel', and 'Done'.

3.7 Else Path – Rejected Request

What

Configure the **Else** branch to handle requests that do not satisfy the approval condition.

Why

A rejected request must not continue through the normal approved processing path. Updating the record provides clear visibility into the rejection.

How

1. Select the **Else** branch of the If condition.
2. Add **Update Record**.
3. Select the Network Database record created earlier.
4. Configure the appropriate rejected status.
5. Save the action.

Network Request Inactive

5 If Request is Approved

6 then **Update Network Database Record**

Action Properties

Action: Update Record

Action Inputs

- * Record: 2 - Cr... Network Database ...
- * Table: Network Database [u_network_d...]
- * Fields:
 - Assigned To: ITIL User
 - Work Status: Approved

+ Add field value

Buttons: Delete, Cancel, Done

Outcome

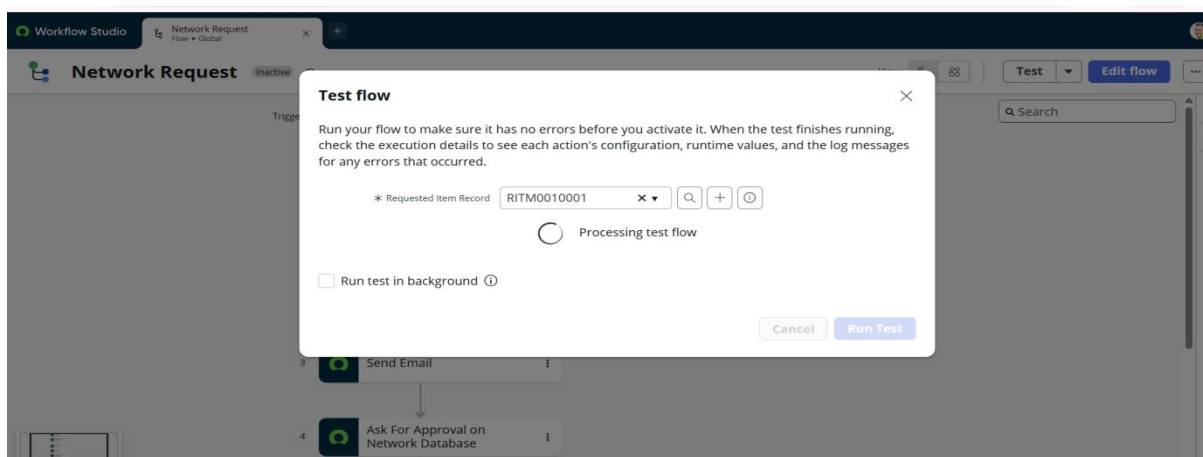
Rejected requests are automatically identified and updated without continuing through the approved-request path.

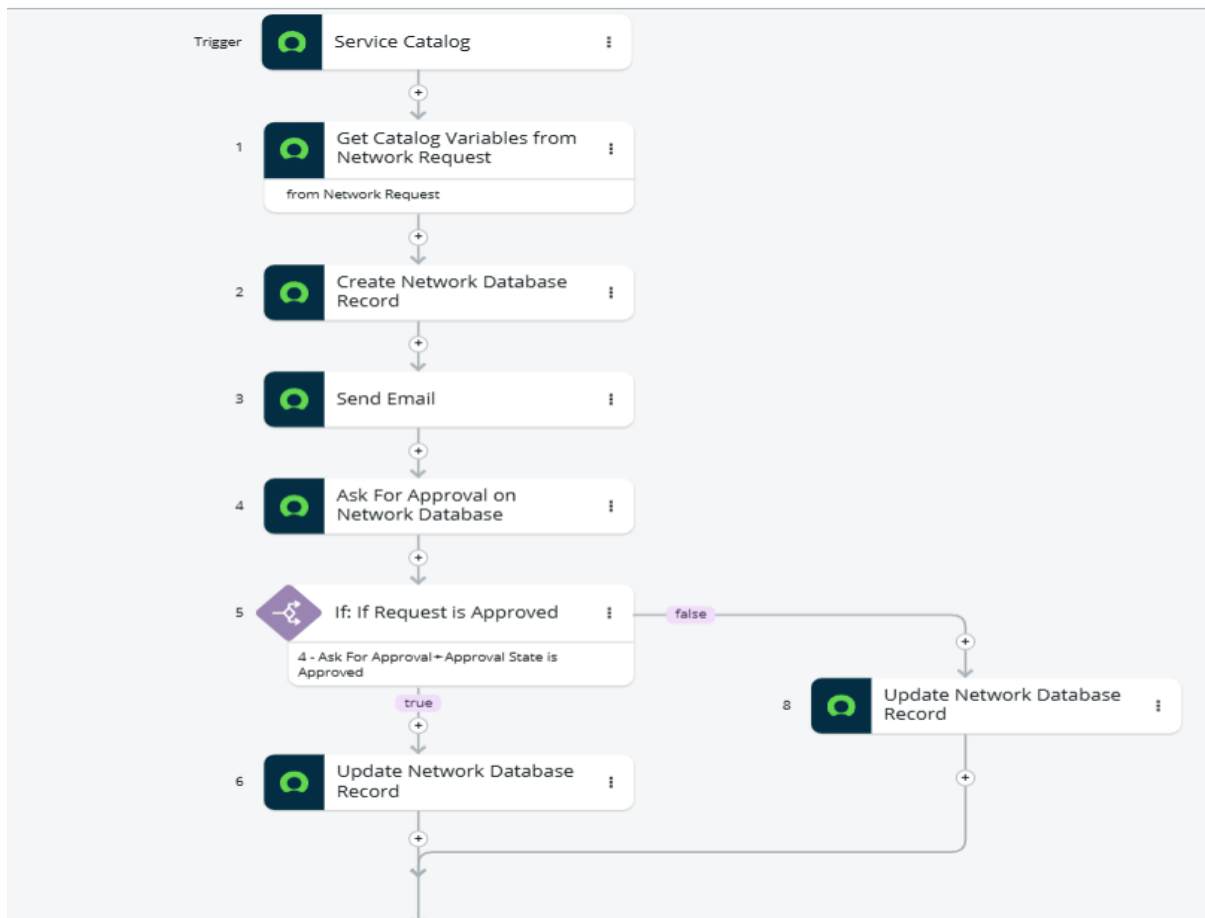
The Automation phase establishes an end-to-end automated Network Request lifecycle in ServiceNow.

The completed automation performs the following sequence:

Catalog Submission → Retrieve Request Data → Create Network Database Record → Send Notification → Request Approval → Evaluate Decision → Update Record

This minimizes manual processing, standardizes request handling, improves approval traceability, and ensures that the Network Database record remains synchronized with the request's current lifecycle status.





Workflow Studio

Network Request
Flow • Global

Network Request
Flow execution • None

EXECUTION DETAILS

Network Request

Test Run - Completed

Open flow

Open context record

TRIGGER

Catalog Item Requested

ACTIONS

1

Get Catalog Variables from Network Request

Core Action

Completed

2026-09-05 08:43:05

26ms

2

Create Record

Core Action

Completed

2026-09-05 08:43:05

11ms

3

Send Email

Completed

2026-09-05 08:43:05

40ms

4

Ask For Approval

Core Action

Completed

2026-09-05 08:43:05

124ms

▼ 5

If If Request is Approved

Flow Logic

Evaluated - True

2026-09-05 08:43:50

8ms

6

Update Record

Core Action

Completed

2026-09-05 08:43:50

6ms

▼ 7

Else

Flow Logic

Not Run

8

Update Record

Core Action

Not Run

ERROR HANDLER

Replicability Note

The flow should be configured using dynamic data pills wherever possible. For example, the Network Database record created by **Create Record** should be reused as the target record for

subsequent **Send Email, Ask for Approval, and Update Record** actions. This ensures that all actions operate on the same request record and makes the automation easier to maintain.